



DoView Tool E9 - Delegating Resourcing Trade-Offs When Amalgamating Agencies Risk Checklist

This tool is used to decide when to amalgamate agencies or departments in the light of the fact that when politicians (or others, for instance, the board of a large company) do so, they can end up inadvertently delegating resource allocation trade-offs down to the management of the new mega-agency/department.

1. Has the use of cross-agency/department DoView strategy/outcomes diagram coordination been tried to ensure inter-agency/department coordination before amalgamation is being used? IF NO, TRY IT FIRST. (See the Cross-Agency (Or Sector) DoView Strategy/Outcomes Diagram Coordination Tool (B19)).
2. Does the newly amalgamated agency/department have an area of work that is particularly technical or high-risk, which is likely to lead it to neglect other outcome areas? (e.g. a Homeland Security Agency might end up with its focus on managing risk around terrorism, leading it to neglect its focus on natural disaster management when this responsibility is added to its work). IF YES, DON'T AMALGAMATE OR MITIGATE RISK.
3. Can you ring-fence funding for a particular outcome area so the agency/department will put sufficient effort into it? IF YES, CONSIDER RING-FENCING.
4. Can an independent advisory board or group be set up to monitor and advise on the level of the agency/department's activity and focus on a particular outcome area? IF YES, CONSIDER SETTING UP.
5. Is it likely that the independent advisory group will be captured by the agency/department? IF SO, MAKE IT INDEPENDENT OF AGENCY/DEPARTMENT MANAGEMENT, CONSIDER HAVING IT REPORT DIRECTLY TO POLITICIANS/BOARD, CONSIDER GIVING IT FORMAL INDEPENDENCE AND POWERS OF INQUIRY.
6. Has a formal DoView strategy/outcomes diagram been developed for the newly amalgamated agency/department that can be used to check that there is alignment between the agency/department's resource allocation and the priority outcome areas that it should be focusing on? IF NOT, WHY NOT?

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